

## Unit 2: Composing Music

### Overview

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#### Content overview

Composing music emphasises the creative aspect of music and allows students to appreciate the process of creating music. Students will be introduced to the technical and creative skills required by a composer. Students will be encouraged to explore a range of compositional starting points and investigate a range of techniques for developing and manipulating ideas, and turn them into completed pieces of music.

Students can also explore the skills needed to arrange music for different musical forces.

#### Assessment overview

In this unit students develop musical ideas in the form of compositions and/or arrangements.

They may choose to submit either:

- **two** compositions, or
- **two** arrangements, or
- **one** composition and **one** arrangement.

Each piece must be based on a different Area of Study.

The overall length of the submission, ie both pieces, should total between two and four minutes.

Group compositions are not acceptable.

Each student submission must comprise:

- **either** a notated score (either handwritten or printed) **or** a written commentary containing sufficient performance directions to allow for a realisation of the piece
- a recording (on CD/MD/MP3).

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Students may compose for either conventional or electronic instruments. The use of technology may be assessed where appropriate using the optional criterion: Use of technology. This may include amplified instruments and their effects, electronic instruments (including MIDI workstations, samplers and record decks) and any technological procedures which are integral to the compositional process or musical idiom and style, for example sequencing, mixing, sound synthesis and processing. However, the use of technology to produce and print scores will not be assessed.

Compositions may be completed at any time during the course.

At an appropriate point during the course, the compositions will be recorded and assessed by the teacher-examiner.

At the end of the course a sample of compositions must be made available for moderation, recorded on CD/MD/MP3.

### **Controlled conditions**

While composition research may be carried out by the student in or out of the centre, the final recording and score or commentary must be completed in the centre under teacher supervision.

The centre supervised time allocation for this component is 10 hours for each of the two compositions.

Reference should be made to page 66 for further guidance on the administration of controlled assessment.

A signed authentication statement must accompany all submissions.

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## Detailed unit content

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